

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 2
 ♥ 9 7 6 3
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ K 8 4

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ K 8 3



♠ 9 7 4 3

♥ J 10 5 2

♦ K 2

♣ J 6 4

♠ Q J 10

♥ A Q

♦ 10 8 7

♣ A Q 10 9 5

Of course you open 1NT. Partner responds 2NT.

With 15 points you decline invitations, and with 17 points you accept. But with 16 you have to use your judgement. Some players will just automatically bid 3NT when they have 16 points, preferring to err on the side of boldness than to possibly miss bidding a makeable game. Others prefer to base their decision on how good the hand looks.

With all the 10s and 9s this hand is stronger than 16 points, so you bid 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ J 6 4 2
♦ K J 9 7 6 5
♣ J 3

♠ A K 3
♥ A K 7
♦ 10 8 2
♣ Q 10 7 5

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♠ 9 8 7 4 2
♥ 10 5 3
♦ 3
♣ K 6 4 2

♠ Q J 10 5
♥ Q 9 8
♦ A Q 4
♣ A 9 8

West	North	East	South
Pass	4NT		1NT
All Pass			
4NT by South			

You open 1NT. Again. This time partner jumps to 4NT.

Partner's bid is **not** Blackwood. It is called a Quantitative 4NT and he is telling you he has a balanced 16-17 point hand. He is inviting you to bid 6NT.

With 17 you accept invitations, with 15 you decline. You have 15 so you pass.

As you see, there are 9 easy tricks and you can probably set up another. But you have no chance to make slam.